

TRULY, MADLY, DEADLY

MESSENGERS OF SORROW, FUTURE WEAPONS
WILL UNLEASH EPIC MAYHEM

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The drumroll of war is beating hard from all directions. Look around you, and you'll see. There's a heightening of rhetoric and extreme posturing between nation states around the world. Armament acquisition is on the rise, defence spending is at an all-time high and everyone seems on the edge. It seems like a schoolyard standoff, where two bullies are calling each other names, provoking the other one to throw the first punch, while friends (and general onlookers) surround them with bated breath, unsure of what will happen. But alas, the standoff amidst nation states isn't so harmless, and if unresolved can have far-reaching consequences.

Why? Because the instruments of war have evolved drastically from what we read about them through the pages of history, as they are far more destructive than ever before. It's alarmingly shocking how much power just a minor click of a button holds in today's age. It's possible to not only blow up enemy targets without engaging them directly in the battlefield, but virtually hack into critical enemy infrastructure and disrupt or takedown their defence, financial, corporate systems to wreck serious havoc and unleash mayhem on your target – if you choose to do so.

Welcome to advanced warfare. And this is not a game. Let's look at the armaments of destruction.

Swarmbots: The biggest substitute to infantry on the battlefield are advanced robot armies that behave like a swarm of insects. Remember Starship Troopers and the swarms of space insects sprawling across unknown planets? Now imagine if all of these insects were actually bots



Swarmbots - the future of infantry

with an impregnable exoskeleton, all controlled by a remote defence station which instructs the swarm of bots to capture a particular enemy territory. These bots can be armed with weapons and be dropped from an aircraft to fly as an army of lethal pests, overrunning a designated territory at speeds of 0.9 Mach – that's 90 per cent of the speed of sound. Details provided by the

US Department of Defense's Strategic Capabilities Office claims that these swarmbots are capable of operating missions in extreme weather ranging from the sub-zero climes of Alaska to the stroke-inducing heat of dusty Iraq. And it isn't just air where these swarmbots will operate, as the Department of Defense has carried out tests in fleets of autonomous boats capable of attacking enemy ships.



Carpet bombing - a relic of the past

Smartbomb: You might have seen clips of indiscriminate carpet bombing of mountainous regions of Afghanistan by US Air Force back in 2004 targeting Al Qaeda operatives, including Osama Bin Laden, who were all crossing over to Pakistan through underground tunnels. Footage of that kind may well be relegated to history books, as smarter targeting technology is ushering in